*Experiment - 08*

# Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application

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## AIM

To configure user management and role-based access control (RBAC) in the Hotel Booking application in Zoho Creator, using permission sets, roles, a role hierarchy and data sharing, so that each user gets only the access needed for their work.

## PROCEDURE

RBAC controls access by giving every user a role and a permission set. The permission set decides what the user can do with the components of the application, and the role decides which records the user can see through the role hierarchy. Figure 1 shows the model and Figure 2 shows the hierarchy planned for the Hotel Booking application.

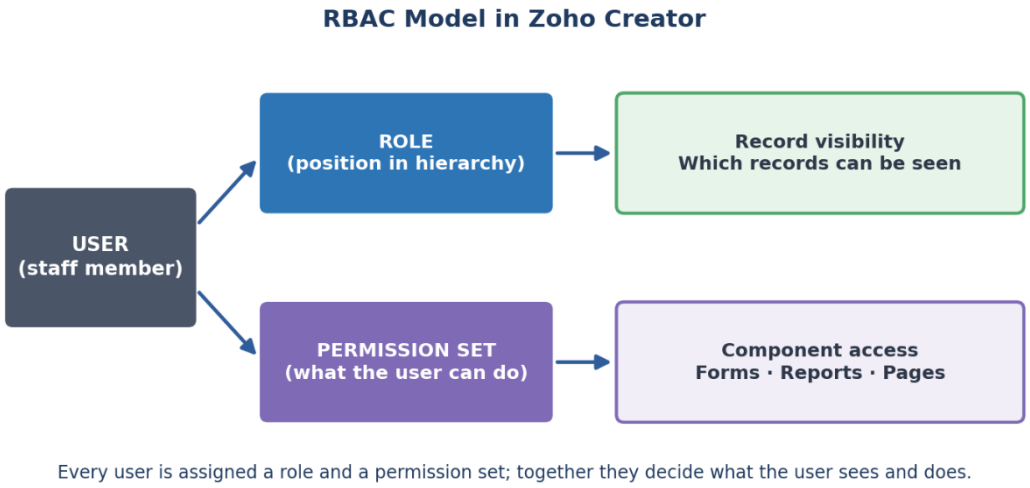



*Figure 1: RBAC Model in Zoho Creator (Conceptual Diagram)*




*Figure 2: Role Hierarchy of the Hotel Booking Application (Conceptual Diagram)*

The planned access of each role is summarised in Table 1.

| Role | Hotel Booking Form | Bookings Report | Dashboard |
|---|---|---|---|
| CEO | Add, view, edit, delete | View all | View |
| Hotel Manager | Add, view, edit, delete | View all | View |
| Front-Desk Staff | Add, view, edit | View | No access |
| Housekeeping Supervisor | View only | View | No access |

*Table 1: Planned Access of Each Role*

## Phase A: Open User Permissions

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the Hotel Booking application in Edit mode.
2. Click Settings and select User Permissions. The tabs Permissions, Roles and Data Sharing are displayed.

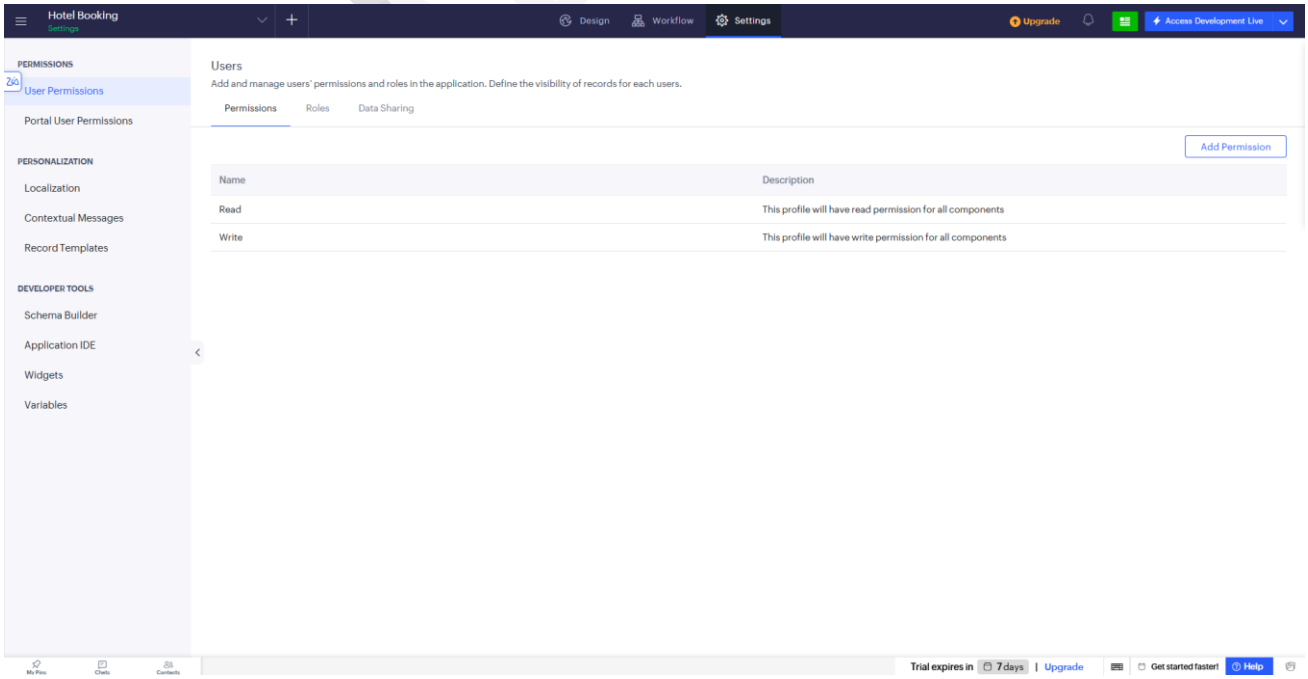



*Figure 3: User Permissions Page of the Hotel Booking Application*

## Phase B: Review and Add Permission Sets

3. Open the Permissions tab. Two predefined permission sets are listed: Read, with read permission for all components, and Write, with write permission for all components.
4. Click Add Permission, enter a name such as Front Desk and a description, and select the components that this permission set may access, as in Table 1.
5. Save the permission set.

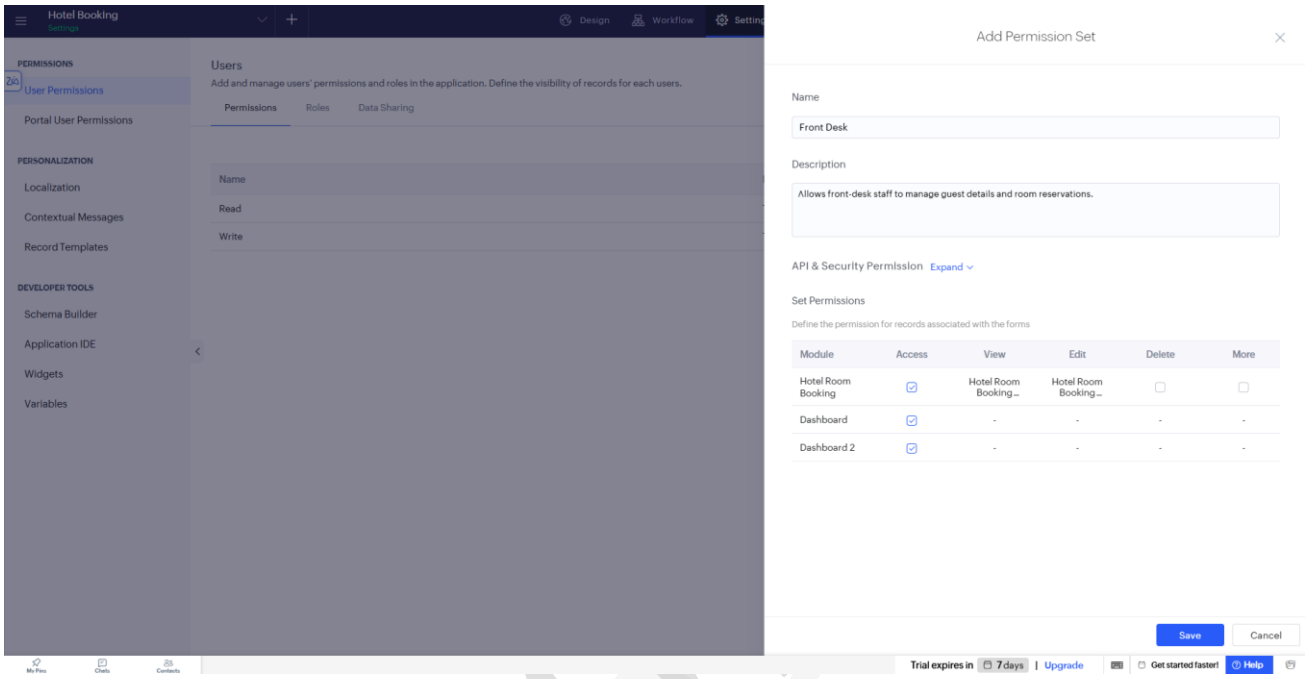



*Figure 4: Permissions Tab with the Predefined and the New Permission Sets*

## Phase C: Create Roles

6. Open the Roles tab. The default role CEO is displayed with the options Expand All, Collapse All, Manage Role Hierarchy and Add Role.
7. Click Add Role and enter the details given in Table 2 for each role.
8. Save the role, then use Manage Role Hierarchy to check that the roles are arranged as in Figure 2.

| Role Name | Reports To | Description |
|---|---|---|
| Hotel Manager | CEO | Manages hotel room reservations and staff |
| Front-Desk Staff | Hotel Manager | Creates and updates reservations |
| Housekeeping Supervisor | Hotel Manager | Views room and booking status |

*Table 2: Role Details (Share Data with Peers Not Selected)*

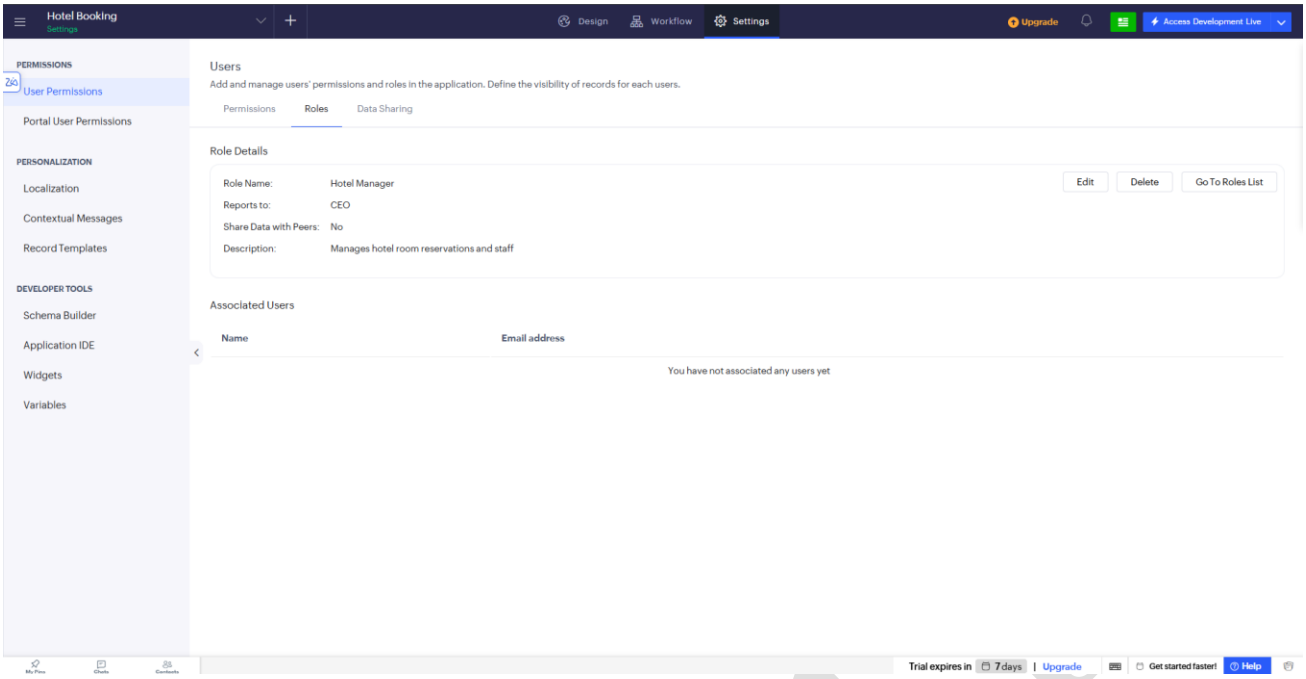



*Figure 5: Roles Tab and Add Role Panel*

## Phase D: Add Users

9. Open the Users section of the account, or the invite option of the application.
10. Click Add User, enter the email address of the staff member and choose the Hotel Booking application.
11. Assign the permission set and the role to the user, for example Front Desk and Front-Desk Staff, and send the invitation.
12. Repeat for each staff member and check that every user appears in the Users list.

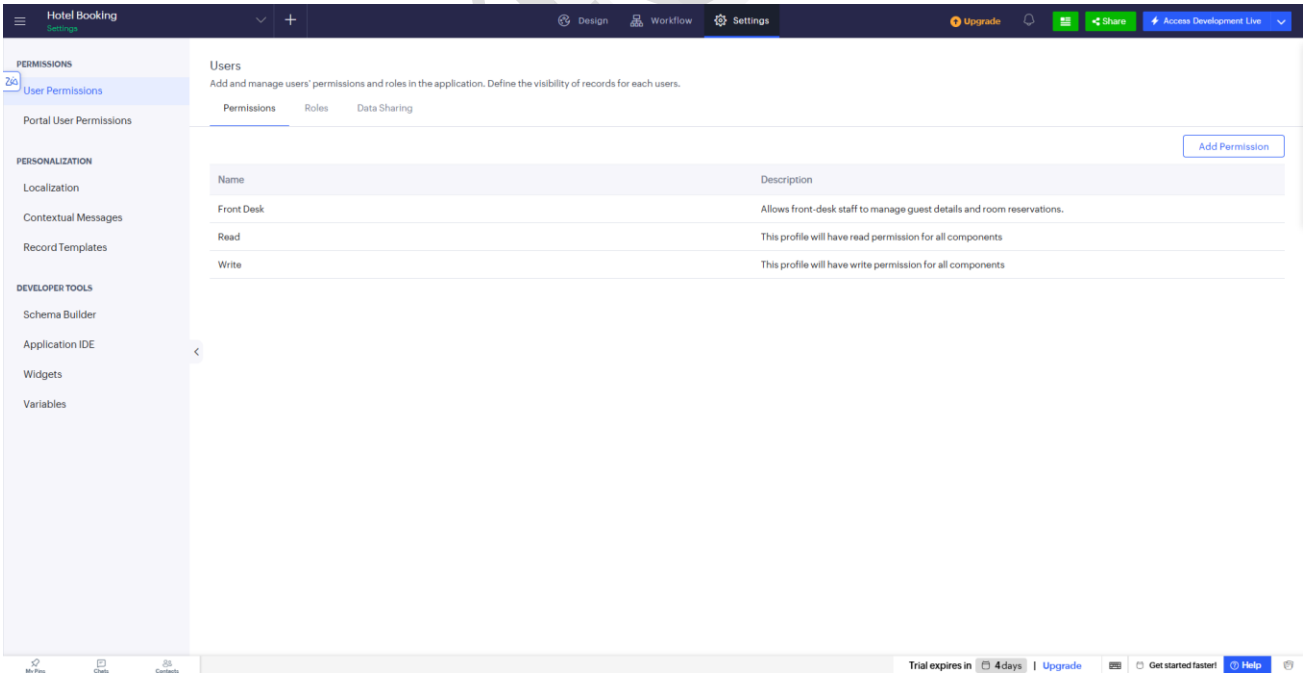



*Figure 6: Users Added to the Hotel Booking Application with Their Roles*

## Phase E: Configure Data Sharing

13. Open the Data Sharing tab and click New Share Rule.
14. Enter the details given in Table 3 and save the rule.

| Parameter | Value |
|---|---|
| Rule Name | Booking Data Sharing |
| Form | Hotel Room Booking |
| Shared From | Hotel Manager (role) |
| Shared To | Housekeeping Supervisor (role) |
| Access Level | Read |

*Table 3: Data Sharing Rule*

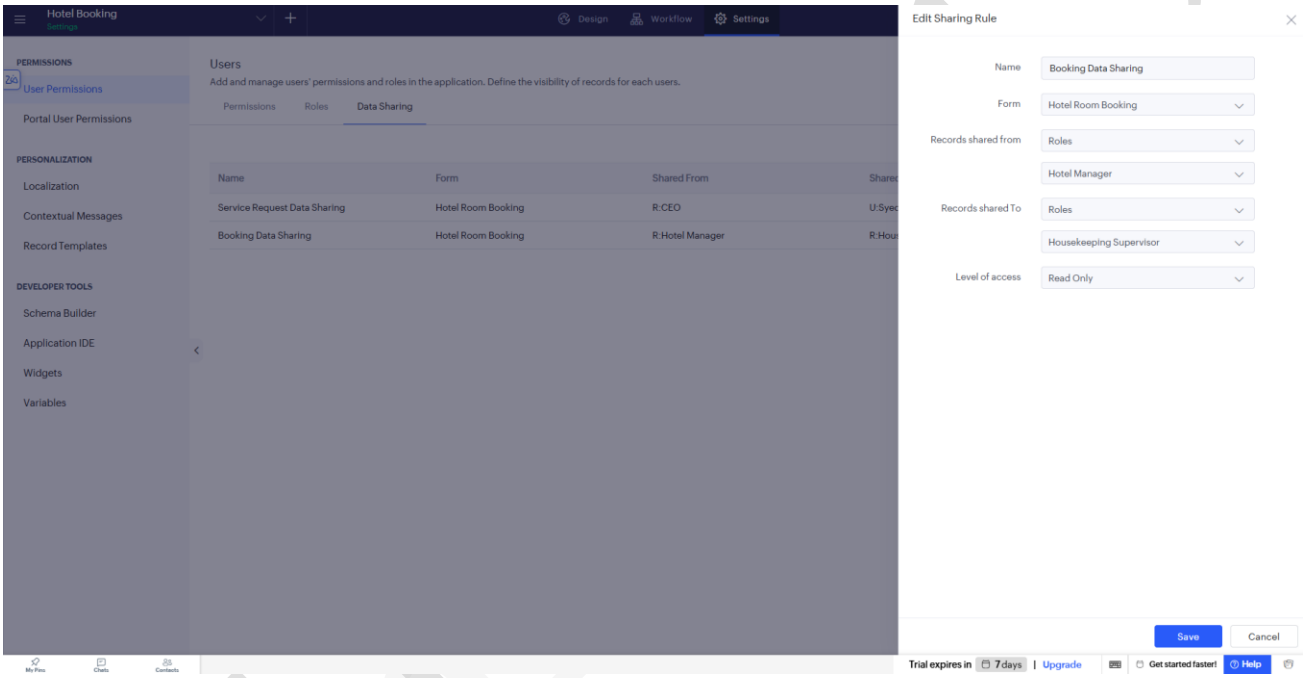



*Figure 7: Data Sharing Rule for the Hotel Room Booking Form*

## Phase F: Test the Access Control

15. Sign in to the application with each user account, for example in a separate browser window.
16. Check which forms, reports and pages each user can see, and which actions are available.
17. Compare the result with Table 1 and correct the permission set or role if there is a difference.

Figure 8 summarises how the access of a user is decided during these tests.

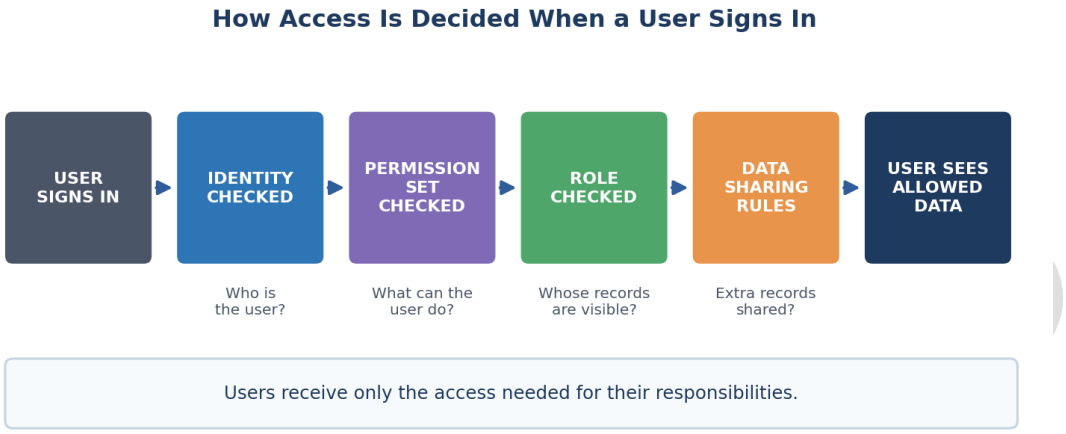



*Figure 8: How Access Is Decided When a User Signs In (Conceptual Diagram)*

Some options, such as saving custom roles or portal user permissions, may depend on the plan of the Zoho Creator account. Any option that is restricted by the plan should be noted as an observation.

## OUTPUT

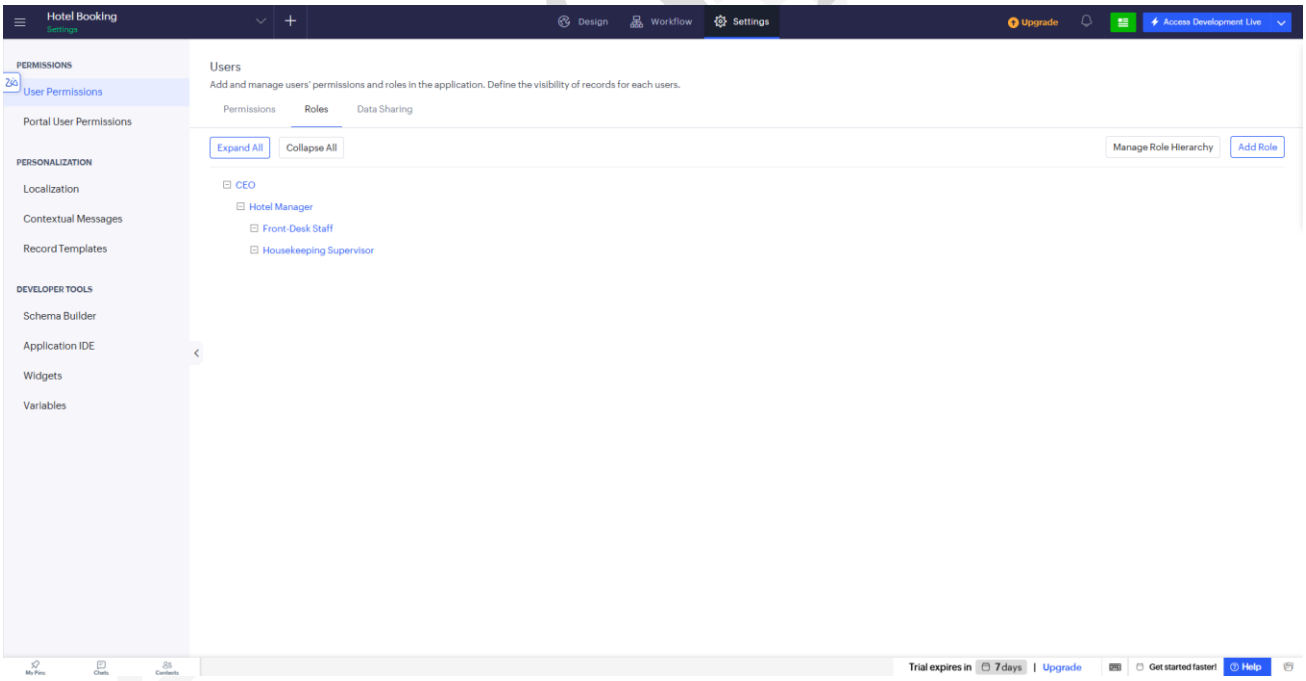



*Figure 9: Role Hierarchy Showing CEO, Hotel Manager, Front-Desk Staff and Housekeeping Supervisor*

| User / Role | Access Observed | Expected as per Table 1 |
|---|---|---|
| CEO | All forms, reports and the dashboard | Matches |
| Front-Desk Staff | Booking form and report; no dashboard | Matches |
| Housekeeping Supervisor | Booking report in read-only mode | Matches |

*Table 4: Access Observed for Each Role*

- **Permission sets:** the predefined Read and Write permissions and the new permission set were available.
- **Roles:** the role hierarchy was displayed with the roles reporting to the CEO.
- **Users:** each user was given a role and a permission set, and the access matched the design.
- **Data sharing:** the rule extended the visibility of booking records to the chosen role at the Read level.

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## RESULT

User management and role-based access control were configured in the Hotel Booking application using permission sets, roles, a role hierarchy, users and a data sharing rule. Testing showed that each user could access only the components and records meant for their role, which protects booking data and supports the principle of least privilege.